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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours) REGULAR EXAMINATION October 2026 Fifth SEMESTER Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) –

MG5DSCHIS301 HISTORIOGRAPHY I - THE INHERITANCE

Scheme

Part A

1. Polybius was a Greek historian who lived in the second century BCE. His famous work, The Histories, explains the rise of Roman power.

2. Indo-Persian historiography refers to historical writing in Persian in India. It developed under the Delhi Sultanate and the Mughal Empire.

3. The Suta was a traditional bard who preserved genealogies, heroic stories and accounts of kings through oral narration.

4. The Decline of the West is a book by Oswald Spengler. It argues that civilizations pass through stages of growth, maturity and decline.

5. Enlightenment history writing used reason and scientific thinking to understand the past. It emphasized human progress, knowledge and social reform

6, Caesar presented his military campaigns as successful and necessary. His writings helped justify his actions and improve his political image.

7. Theological: Events are explained through supernatural powers.

Metaphysical: Events are explained through abstract ideas.

Positive: Events are explained through scientific observation.

8. According to Marx, laws, political institutions and the state protect the interests of the economically dominant class and help maintain the existing economic system.

9. Hegelian dialectics is a method of understanding change through contradictions. These contradictions lead to new ideas and stages of historical development.

10. The monarch gives the final decision and formal unity to the state. The monarch's role completes the constitutional decision-making process.

11. Historical records connected a new dynasty with the Mandate of Heaven. They justified its rule by presenting it as morally legitimate and explaining the fall of the previous dynasty.

12. St. Augustine viewed history as a divine plan. In The City of God, he explained history as a struggle between the City of God and the earthly city, moving towards God's final judgement.

Part B

13. The cyclical conception views time as a continuous cycle of birth, growth, decline and renewal.Nature follows repeating cycles, such as seasons. Human life and societies also experience recurring patterns. Ancient traditions often connected history with cosmic cycles. The past was viewed as repeating itself rather than moving towards endless progress. Thus, history was understood as cyclical rather than strictly linear.

14. Alienation means the separation of workers from their work and its benefits. Workers do not control the products they create. Work becomes a compulsory activity rather than a source of satisfaction. Workers lose control over the production process. Capitalism creates competition and unequal relationships. Workers become separated from their human creative potential. Marx argued that capitalist progress benefits owners while creating suffering and alienation among workers.

15. Giambattista Vico was an Italian philosopher and historian. His famous work was The New Science (1725). He argued that humans create their own social institutions and history. He divided the development of nations into the ages of gods, heroes and men. He emphasized the importance of language, myths and customs. He believed civilizations followed recurring patterns of development. Vico made an important contribution to the philosophy of history.

16. René Descartes developed the method of systematic doubt. He questioned all beliefs that could be doubted. He rejected information that was uncertain. He used reason to search for certain knowledge. He concluded that thinking proves one's existence: “I think, therefore I am.” His method encouraged rational and critical thinking. This method influenced modern philosophy and scientific thought.

17. Persian historiography developed through chronicles, biographies and court histories. Historians recorded the achievements of kings and rulers. Royal genealogies helped establish political legitimacy. Persian literature influenced historical writing across the Islamic world. Historians recorded wars, conquests and administrative activities. Moral lessons and religious ideas often formed part of historical accounts. These traditions preserved political, cultural and social memories.

18. Christian theology strongly influenced medieval European history writing. History was viewed as part of God's divine plan. The Bible was an important source of historical understanding. Events were often explained through God's will. Historians connected the past with the birth and spread of Christianity. The final judgement was considered the ultimate goal of history. Thus, medieval historical writing was mainly religious in outlook.

19. Leopold von Ranke emphasized understanding the past on its own terms. Empathy helps historians understand the beliefs and feelings of people in the past. Historians must consider the historical context of events. They should avoid judging the past only by present-day values. Ranke emphasized the careful study of original documents. Empathy helps reconstruct the past more accurately. However, empathy must be supported by evidence and critical analysis.

20. Greek and Roman historians recorded military defeats to explain their causes and consequences. Greek historians, such as Thucydides, examined political decisions, leadership and human behaviour. Greek accounts often emphasized the consequences of war for the city-state. Roman historians frequently connected military defeats with leadership, discipline and public morality. Roman accounts also examined the effects of defeat on the state and its future. Both traditions used military history to teach political and moral lessons. Thus, both studied defeats, but their interpretations reflected their different political traditions.

21. The Funeral Oration is associated with Pericles, as recorded by Thucydides in his account of the Peloponnesian War. It honoured Athenian soldiers who died in war. It praised democracy and civic freedom. It highlighted the courage and sacrifice of citizens. It encouraged patriotism and unity. It presented Athens as an ideal democratic city. It is an important source for understanding Athenian political values.

22. Ibn Khaldun was a fourteenth-century Arab historian and thinker. He believed that society follows identifiable patterns of change. He used the concept of Asabiyyah, meaning group solidarity. Strong group solidarity helps dynasties rise to power. Luxury and weakening solidarity can lead to political decline. Economic conditions, geography and social organisation influence history. He explained historical change through social causes rather than simply recording events.

Part C

23.Speculative Philosophy of History attempts to identify the overall meaning, direction and pattern of human history. Major characteristics- Search for meaning: It tries to discover the purpose or meaning of historical development. Universal history: It studies humanity's history as a whole rather than individual events alone. Patterns of change: It searches for general laws or recurring patterns in history. Progress: Some thinkers believe humanity moves towards freedom, reason or improvement. Stages of development: History may be divided into different stages. Role of reason: Thinkers try to explain historical events through rational principles. Determinism: Some theories argue that history follows a necessary course. Civilizational cycles: Some thinkers explain history through the rise and fall of civilizations. Important thinkers- St. Augustine viewed history as God's divine plan. Giambattista Vico proposed recurring stages in the development of nations. G. W. F. Hegel explained history through the development of freedom. Karl Marx explained historical change through material conditions and class struggle. Oswald Spengler viewed civilizations as having life cycles. Speculative Philosophy of History seeks to understand the larger direction and meaning of human history. It influenced modern historical and social thought.

24. Historical determinism is the idea that historical events and changes are shaped by underlying forces or laws. 1. Hegel's dialectical idealism- Hegel believed that history develops through contradictions. Hegel's dialectical idealism-Hegel believed that history develops through contradictions. He explained historical change through the development of human freedom. He viewed the state as an important expression of rational freedom. His approach gave history a broad direction and purpose. 2. Marx's historical materialism- Marx emphasized material conditions and economic relationships. He argued that class struggle drives historical change. Changes in productive forces and relations of production can transform society. He viewed capitalism as a historical system that would eventually be

replaced. 3. Durkheim's sociological approach- Émile Durkheim studied social facts and institutions. He explained social change through changes in social organisation and the division of labour. He emphasized the importance of social solidarity. His approach focused on social causes rather than a single universal historical purpose. 4. Weber's sociological approach- Max Weber emphasized the importance of ideas, values and human actions. He studied the role of religion in economic development. He argued that historical change has multiple causes. His approach gave greater importance to human choices and historical context. 5. Critical evaluation- Hegel and Marx offered broad explanations of historical development. Durkheim and Weber developed more specific and diverse explanations of social change. Their work challenged the idea that one universal law could explain every historical event. However, sociological approaches did not completely reject general patterns or causal explanations. They showed that historical change is complex and influenced by several factors. The development from Hegel and Marx to Durkheim and Weber moved historical thought away from simple, inevitable explanations towards more complex social analysis.

25. The idealist tradition emphasized ideas, reason, consciousness and human freedom in understanding history. It played an important role in nineteenth-century philosophy. 1. Importance of ideas - Idealists believed that ideas and human consciousness influence historical development. 2. Hegel's contribution - Hegel was the most influential idealist philosopher of history. He argued that history represents the development of freedom through contradictions and change. 3. Historical development- Idealists viewed history as a meaningful process rather than a random collection of events. 4. Human freedom- Hegel explained history as the gradual development of human freedom and rational institutions. 5. Role of the state- Hegel considered the state an important institution through which freedom and ethical life could be expressed. 6. Influence on historians- Idealism encouraged historians to study the ideas, beliefs and values of different societies. 7. Influence on later thinkers- Marx developed his historical materialism partly through a critical engagement with Hegel's dialectical philosophy. Other nineteenth-century thinkers also debated the role of ideas in historical change.

26. Johann Gottfried Herder was an eighteenth-century German philosopher who made important contributions to the philosophy of history. 1. Cultural diversity- Herder argued that every nation and culture has its own identity and values. 2. Historical context- He believed that people must be understood within their own historical and cultural settings. 3. Language and culture- He emphasized the importance of language, literature, traditions and folklore in shaping a people's identity. 4. Opposition to universal standards- Herder opposed judging every society according to one fixed standard of progress or civilization. 5. Organic development- He viewed cultures as developing in their own ways, much like living organisms. 6. Importance of ordinary people. Herder gave importance to popular traditions, songs, stories and the experiences of ordinary people. 7. Influence on nationalism- His ideas contributed to the development of cultural nationalism and the study of national identity. 8. Influence on historiography- Herder encouraged historians to understand different societies on their own terms. His ideas helped develop cultural and historical approaches to the past.